

STUDENT TECHNOLOGY ACCEPTABLE/RESPONSIBLE USE POLICY

The Loudoun County School Board provides technologies, including access to internet, to promote educational excellence by facilitating resource sharing, innovation, and communication. The term technology includes hardware, software, data, communication lines and devices, terminals, printers, servers, mainframe and personal computers, the internet, and other internal or external networks.

A. Purpose. All use of the School Division's technology must be (1) consistent with the educational or instructional mission or administrative function of the School Division as well as the varied instructional needs, learning styles, abilities, and developmental levels of students and/or research, or (2) for legitimate school business. Loudoun County Public Schools (LCPS) may provide students with access to online educational services and websites through contracts with educational companies and vendors. Students may be provided with a username and password to access educational content on these websites. Use of the computer system is a privilege, not a right, where doing so would not be contrary to applicable laws, including Section 504, IDEA, and ADA.

B. Monitoring. LCPS routinely monitors an individual's usage of the School Division's technology. The normal operation and maintenance of the School Division's technical infrastructure and services requires that usage and activity are monitored, data and electronic communications are routinely backed up, and programs or other devices are employed to maintain the functionality, integrity, or security of the network infrastructure. Any communication or material using School Division technology, including electronic mail and documents created, stored, or shared from a user's account, may be monitored, read, recorded, copied, seized, and/or provided to appropriate authorities by school officials without prior notice. Users shall have no right or expectation of privacy. None of the School Division's technologies shall constitute a traditional, limited, or designated public forum. Students shall not send, receive, view, or download illegal materials. This includes any programs, applications, or other platforms designed or used to bypass LCPS's content filtering protections.

C. Content Filtering. The School Division selected and operates technology protection measures that monitor, and filter, and block Internet access for all devices connected to LCPS and LCPS-OPEN. The protections prevent access to the following:

1. Pornography of any kind, including, but not limited to, child pornography;
2. Obscenity; and
3. Material that the School Division deems to be harmful to students and material that is otherwise inappropriate for students.

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D. Technical and Administrative Procedures. The Superintendent shall establish technical and administrative procedures containing the appropriate uses, ethics, and protocols for the technology. The procedures shall include:

1. Provisions establishing that the technology protection measure is enforced during any use of the Division's computers by students;
2. Provisions establishing that the online activities of students will be monitored. Provisions designed to educate students about appropriate online behavior, including, but not limited to, appropriate conduct while interacting with other individuals on social networking websites and in chat rooms, Cyber Bullying awareness and response, sexual harassment, and distribution of lewd or obscene material;
3. Provisions designed to prevent unauthorized online access by minors, including "hacking" and other unlawful activities by minors online;
4. Provisions prohibiting the unauthorized disclosure, use, and dissemination of personal information regarding minors; and,
5. A component on Internet safety for students that is integrated in the School Division's instructional program.

E. Prohibited Applications. No LCPS student may download or use any application, including TikTok or WeChat, or access any website developed by ByteDance Ltd. or Tencent Holdings Ltd. On: (i) any device or equipment issued, owned, or leased by LCPS, including mobile phones, desktop computers, laptop computers, tablets, or other devices capable of connecting to the Internet; or (ii) while connected to any wired or wireless Internet network owned, operated, or maintained by the Commonwealth of Virginia.

All students are expected to use technology responsibly and ethically, ensuring their actions do not cause harm to others or the school community. The use of any device, application, or method that violates these guidelines, tests, manipulates, or bypasses School Division security measures is strictly prohibited.

F. Signature Form. Each student and parent/guardian of each student shall sign the form included in the *Student Rights and Responsibilities Handbook* or online via ParentVue/StudentVue. By doing so, the student and parent/guardian acknowledge to accept the terms of this policy and the failure of any student to follow the terms of this policy or accompanying regulation may result in loss of computer or network system privileges, disciplinary action, as defined in the Student Rights and Responsibilities Handbook, School Board policy, and/or law.

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G. Limited Liability. The School Board is not responsible for any information that may be lost, damaged, or unavailable when using the computer system or for any information retrieved via the Internet. Furthermore, the School Board will not be responsible for any unauthorized charges or fees resulting from access to the computer or network system.

H. Review Process. The School Board will review, amend if necessary, and approve this policy every two years.

[Former Policy 3060]

Adopted: 6/26/18

Revised: 4/11/23, 11/28/23

Current Revision: 11/26/24

Legal Refs.: [18 U.S.C. §§ 2256](#); [47 U.S.C. § 254](#); Code of Virginia, 1950, as amended, §§ [2.2-5514.1](#), [18.2-372](#), [18.2-374.1:1](#), [18.2-390](#), [22.1-70.2](#), and [22.1-78](#)

Cross Refs: Policy [8655](#), Student Personal Device Use